1. Background — TCC Event Clearance App

Nov 8, 2026 · @rogiie

At Tagoloan Community College, students queue twice at every event, once for the SBO signature and once for the attendance sheet. This app replaces both queues with one scan.

Problem today

Every event clearance takes two steps in two lines. First the student waits for an SBO officer to sign each Time In and Time Out box on the paper activity card. Then the student writes their name on a separate attendance sheet.

- **Long waits.** At intramurals every department gathers at once, and each student needs up to four signatures per day (morning and afternoon, in and out).
- **Strict consequences.** One missing Time In or Time Out signature carries a penalty, so students queue even when it costs them event time.
- **Manual attendance.** Compiling attendance by department and section is slow, and so are corrections and printing.
- **Fragile proof.** Proof of attendance depends on a paper card the student must keep clean and safe.

Goals and non-goals

Goals

1. Replace both queues with one scan of about 2 seconds per student.
2. Build attendance automatically, sorted by department, year level and section.
3. Give each student a digital activity card with a signed stamp for every Time In and Time Out.
4. Work with no mobile data at the venue.
5. Make cheating (lending an account, screenshots, AI-edited cards) harder than attending.
6. Let SBOs design a different card for every event.
7. Give officers a web dashboard to edit, export and print.

Non-goals for version 1

- Replacing the registrar's official student records.
- Face recognition or any biometric matching.
- Instructor accounts; approval happens in person.
- Native Play Store or App Store apps.
- Grading, payments or any feature outside event attendance and clearance.

Who uses it

Role	Who	What they need
Student	About 6,000 students in CBA, CIT, CED, CCJPS, CHM, CAS, COM and CLIS	Get signed without queueing and keep a card that proves attendance
Department SBO officer	Officers assigned to each department, plus officers such as the mayor or vice mayor who scan in classrooms	Scan fast, check cards, approve registrations from their own department
Head SBO officer	Campus-level officers	Create and publish events, manage officers, see all departments
Instructor or adviser	No account	Approves the card details and design in person; the name is printed on the card

Decisions made so far

Topic	Decision
Platform	Installable web app (PWA): one codebase for Android, iPhone and the officer dashboard
Install	The app shows only an install screen until it is installed; it is gated, not force-downloaded
Sign-in	Google (Gmail) account, plus school ID, name, department, year level and section

Topic	Decision
Registration approval	The department SBO approves new registrations; no registrar data import
Photo	Live camera only, one clear face checked on the device; the SBO rejects a bad photo at the scanner, which forces a retake
Check-in	The student shows a rotating QR and the SBO scans it, offline
Location check	Optional per event and per venue, off by default, flag-only when on
Venues	One event can have several pinned venues; any officer can scan at any venue
Time slots	Up to four per day (morning in and out, afternoon in and out), configurable per event
Activity card	A template per event, never generalized; AI draws artwork only, and text and signature boxes are real
Card checking	Only on the SBO "Check card" screen; no teacher accounts
Students without a working phone	Manual check-in by the SBO, plus a handwritten signature on the printed card
Event approval	The instructor approves in person; the SBO records "Approved by" and the date

Assumptions and open questions

Assumptions

- About 6,000 students; the largest department (CCJPS) has about 10 sections and CIT has 6. These are estimates.
- This is a personal initiative that will be presented to the school; hosting uses free or low-cost tiers.
- Students own smartphones in most cases, and the rare exception is handled by manual check-in.

Open questions

- [ ] Instructor or dean confirms a digital card counts as valid clearance, including a dispute process when a phone fails.
- [ ] Send sample cards from other events (the CIT Intramurals 2026 card is received).
- [ ] Confirm section counts per department.
- [ ] Brief the school's data protection officer (Data Privacy Act, RA 10173).
- [ ] Confirm where wifi is available for registration days and syncing.